Susan Calvin

BSc Biosciences student | Laboratory skills | Data analysis in R

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PROFILE

Reliable first-year BSc Biosciences student at the University of Liverpool, building practical laboratory, quantitative and scientific communication skills. Follows written procedures, records results accurately and maintains hygiene standards, shown in a work experience placement and a busy cinema role. Uses R for statistical analysis and applies generative AI responsibly as a study aid, always checking outputs for accuracy. Motivated to apply my biology knowledge in a practical setting, learn how quality systems (GLP, GMP and SHE) work in a pharmaceutical laboratory, and contribute to a team that delivers safe, effective medicines to patients.

EDUCATION

BSc Biosciences September 2026 - present
University of Liverpool

- First year. Modules: Practical Laboratory and Quantitative Skills; Core Concepts in Biology; Study and Communication Skills.

A levels 2024 - 2026
Oakfield Sixth Form College, Warrington

- Biology (B), Geography (B), Chemistry (C).

GCSEs 2019 - 2024
Oakfield High School, Warrington

- Biology (7), Geography (7), Chemistry (6), Physics (6), Mathematics (6), English Language (6), English Literature (5), History (5), French (5).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Laboratory: Basic laboratory equipment; following written procedures; recording results accurately; hygiene and safe working practice.

Data and statistics: R programming for statistical analysis, data cleaning and visualisation; interpreting results and communicating findings clearly; Microsoft Excel.

Generative AI: Responsible use of generative AI tools for study planning, revision, understanding complex topics and improving drafts, with critical evaluation of outputs.

Digital: Microsoft Word, PowerPoint and Excel; online learning systems.

COURSEWORK

Practical Laboratory and Quantitative Skills | University of Liverpool, 2026

- Build hands-on laboratory skills, working with basic equipment, following written procedures and recording results.
- Use R to clean data, run statistical analyses, create visualisations and interpret results, then explain findings clearly in writing.

Core Concepts in Biology and Study and Communication Skills | University of Liverpool, 2026

- Develop a foundation in core biological concepts and the skills to analyse and present scientific information.

GENERATIVE AI AND RESPONSIBLE PRACTICE

- Use generative AI to plan study, support revision and break down complex topics, then verify the content against lecture notes, textbooks and reliable scientific sources.
- Draft and improve my own work with AI feedback while keeping authorship, and follow university assessment rules on what AI use is permitted.
- Evaluate AI outputs critically for errors, bias and unsupported claims, and never treat them as a replacement for my own understanding.
- Protect confidential and personal information by not entering it into AI tools.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Work Experience Placement July 2025
Willowbank Animal Rescue Centre, Cheshire (one week, arranged through sixth form)

- Followed staff instructions and hygiene procedures when cleaning small-animal enclosures, helping keep a safe, clean environment for the animals.
- Prepared food and organised donated supplies so that stock was easy to find and use.
- Observed staff carrying out routine animal care, and learned why consistent procedures and hygiene standards matter in work where accuracy and welfare are important.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Usher (part-time) January 2026 - present
Westbrook Cinema, Warrington

- Check tickets, direct customers to screens and answer questions accurately.
- Clean and prepare screens between films and keep public areas tidy, so each screening starts to a consistent standard.
- Help customers with seating issues and report problems promptly to the duty manager.

Confectionery Assistant (part-time) June 2024 - December 2025
Westbrook Cinema, Warrington

- Served customers at busy weekend and evening peaks, handling cash and card payments on the till.
- Followed food hygiene procedures, restocked products and helped close the counter at the end of shifts.

Volunteer March - May 2025
Friends of Sankey Valley Park

- Attended three weekend litter-picking and habitat maintenance sessions, working with other volunteers to collect litter and clear pathways.

TRANSFERABLE SKILLS

Problem-solving: Resolve customer seating issues and escalate problems to the duty manager.

Teamwork: Work with different colleagues on busy cinema shifts and with volunteers outdoors.

Communication: Confident speaking to customers; ask colleagues for advice when needed.

Organisation: Balance university study with a part-time job and meet coursework deadlines.

Attention to detail: Handle payments accurately, follow written procedures and record results.

Independent learning: Use university resources, online learning systems and AI tools responsibly to build understanding.

INTERESTS AND ACTIVITIES

Visiting zoos and wildlife parks and learning about animal species; photographing birds and wildlife on countryside walks; planning to join the university wildlife society. Also enjoy swimming, reading and the cinema with friends.

Available for part-time and weekend work in term time, and more hours during university holidays.

REFEREE

Dr. Robert Treharne (Academic Advisor)
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